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The Key

Education is a growing market value in today's society. The more education one has the higher status and better job positions one will have. However, without the proper tools and education one cannot properly succeed in today's world. A perfect example would be the state of New Mexico. This state is ranked 49th in education and it has to do with budget cuts, school segregation, and teacher turn overs. All these issues contribute to the poor grading and results that New Mexico receives. Overall, this is affecting not only New Mexico but the United states as a whole because the youth today is the future of America. The severe budget cuts made in education, school segregation, and teacher turn overs contribute to New Mexico being ranked one of the poorest states, in education, in the United States.

Firstly, schools today are segregated not legally through race but socioeconomically. Often the students that attend poor schools tend to live in poor neighborhoods and do not have the proper resources to fully succeed unlike other schools in New Mexico. The schools are not receiving proper funding "the current formula does not direct adequate resources to cover the incremental costs needed to educate at-risk students, and that other states direct more funds to their at-risk students that are living in poverty or those that are English Language Learners" (NM

Center on Law and Poverty 10). This means that students that attend these schools that are not fully funded cannot properly have their needs met. For example, many of the students attending these poor schools in New Mexico often experience child hunger and don't have the proper means to sufficiently afford school lunches and therefore go to school hungry and cannot properly concentrate on their school work. As well as properly provide adequate books and materials for the students to use. The segregation due to socioeconomic status is not intentional; however, it is present within the school systems. Schools being divided based off economic status hurts the students learning because a lot of the people tend to be the same race and ethnicity which therefore also takes away the diversity that kids experience as well. These schools are no longer diverse in New Mexico and are being constricted to one's socioeconomic living standard. This needs to change in New Mexico if it no longer wants to be 49th in education

Secondly, recent budget cuts will also affect the way that education will be handled in a classroom. In New Mexico, the state does not properly have enough funding already to efficiently support the students and give them proper resources and now it will have even less with Susana Martinez's recent budget cuts. This is a serious issue because "As of 2013, New Mexico spent \$9,013 per pupil, compared to a national average of \$10,700" (Sams) Thus shows that New Mexico is already not spending enough money on its students and that they are unable to meet the needs of the pupil fully. Without enough funding, students will not have the proper resources to succeed and eventually hurt the economy even more. This will also affect each school in New Mexico differently since they all receive different amounts allocated to them. For example, the students that live in more poverty stricken areas are receiving less funding than other schools within New Mexico that are not.

Lastly, another reason that New Mexico is ranked so low in education is teacher turn overs. People are not particularly interested in becoming teachers and especially not in New Mexico. Many people that are teachers are also leaving the field because of strict and harsh regulations in terms of test scores related to teachers' salaries. . For example, "New Mexico teachers “strongly agree” that test scores could negatively affect their employment." (Burgess) this is because many of the teacher's raise advancements and evaluations are heavenly dependent on testing like the PARCC test. Thus at least half teachers current evaluations are dependent on evaluations similar to these. Teachers; therefore, feel that their work and evaluations do not fully reflect their performance in the classroom. Moreover, teachers' salaries are so not affordable. For instance, " New Mexico teachers' starting salaries are comparatively small – \$31,960 on average in 2013 compared with the \$36,141 national average." (Burgess). Thus showing that teachers are being paid lower than average which is why they do not want to. This contributes to the ranking of New Mexico education because if students so not have enough teachers then more and more students will be held in one class room and student teacher ratios will be too high to give each student enough attention to learn adequately.

Overall, New Mexico has great strides to make in order to better the education of this generation and the future generations. This will ultimately help not only students further their education but will also raise the economy as well. Education is such an important thing for success and it needs to be accessible to every student as well as easy to provide by its instructors. Hopefully, New Mexico governors, senators, and congressman can do whatever is on the best interest of the students and educators so that everyone is able to successfully do his or her job. The future is in the hands of the youth and, therefore, it is necessary for each and every person to

succeed. Education is like a key, without America cannot open the door for the future youth to move forward.

Works Cited

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